Competitive Intelligence Brief

stripe

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Executive Overview: Stripe provides payment processing software and APIs for e-commerce websites and mobile applications, enabling businesses to accept online payments and manage their financial operations.

Market Landscape: Analyzing 4 key competitors: Fiserv, J.P. Morgan Payments, GoCardless, Mollie

■ High-Impact Strategic Roadmap

Decision 1: Develop and launch a targeted regional banking partnership program in the US, offering co-branded or integrated Stripe solutions for SMBs, focusing initially on the Western United States.

Reason: To directly counter Fiserv's strategy of expanding its regional bank footprint for SMBs with its Clover POS platform, which could otherwise lead to a loss of potential merchant accounts for Stripe in this key segment.

Evidence: Fiserv partnered with Western Alliance Bank to offer its Clover POS and business management platform, expanding its regional bank footprint in the Western United States.

Outcome: Increase Stripe's SMB merchant acquisition by 15% in targeted regional markets within 12 months and secure new transaction volume from these partnerships. | Confidence: 90%

Decision 2: Accelerate the development and market launch of a proprietary, integrated in-person payment terminal and associated 'Tap to Pay' app specifically tailored for UK SMBs, ensuring seamless integration with Stripe's online offerings.

Reason: To address the competitive threat posed by Mollie's new proprietary terminal and Tap app, which aims to capture market share among UK SMBs seeking integrated online and offline payment solutions.

Evidence: Mollie launched its new proprietary payment terminal and Tap app to support UK SMBs with in-person payments.

Outcome: Retain and grow Stripe's market share among UK SMBs for in-person payments by 10% within 18 months, preventing erosion of transaction volume and merchant acquisition. | Confidence: 85%

Decision 3: Prioritize and fast-track the full commercial rollout and aggressive marketing of Stripe's Variable Recurring Payments (VRPs) solution in the UK, emphasizing its 'Pay by Bank' capabilities and merchant benefits.

Reason: To mitigate GoCardless's first-mover advantage and strong positioning in the emerging VRP market in the UK, which could otherwise lead to significant market share loss in the crucial recurring payments segment.

Evidence: GoCardless is involved in the live testing and rollout of commercial Variable Recurring Payments (VRPs) in the UK with its 'Recurring Pay by Bank' solution.

Outcome: Capture at least 20% of the new VRP transaction volume in the UK within 24 months, securing future revenue streams and maintaining a competitive edge in recurring payments. | Confidence: 90%

Decision 4: Launch a global marketing campaign and product enhancement initiative highlighting Stripe's unified, end-to-end payment platform, emphasizing its scalability,

developer-friendliness, and comprehensive payment method support.

Reason: To reinforce Stripe's established strength as a comprehensive payment provider against competitors like GoCardless (transitioning) and Mollie (acquiring GoCardless) who are actively working to achieve an end-to-end model.

Evidence: GoCardless is transitioning from a Direct Debit specialist to an end-to-end payment provider, and Mollie is acquiring GoCardless to expand its offerings.

Outcome: Increase new merchant acquisition by 10% globally within 12 months by attracting businesses seeking a single, scalable payment partner and reducing churn to consolidating competitors. | Confidence: 80%

Decision 5: Enhance and aggressively market Stripe's existing 'Pay by Bank' and Account-to-Account (A2A) payment options, particularly for enterprise-level merchants in sectors like online grocery and retail, emphasizing conversion benefits and lower fees.

Reason: To capitalize on the growing consumer preference for direct bank payments and directly counter Fiserv's expansion of 'Pay by Bank' solutions with major retailers like Ahold Delhaize USA.

Evidence: Fiserv expanded partnership with Ahold Delhaize USA to roll out Pay by Bank, a new digital payment option for online grocery orders.

Outcome: Increase transaction volume processed via Stripe's A2A payment methods by 15% within 12 months, maintaining high conversion rates for merchants and securing market position against competitors. | Confidence: 85%

Decision 6: Develop and promote advanced B2B digital card and virtual payment solutions, leveraging Stripe's modern API infrastructure for enhanced automation, reconciliation, and FX capabilities, targeting European and global businesses.

Reason: To capitalize on the growing market need for streamlined B2B payments and directly compete with J.P. Morgan Payments' scaling of its digital card suite across Europe for B2B supply chains and travel payments.

Evidence: J.P. Morgan Payments is scaling its digital card suite across Europe to streamline B2B supply chains and travel payments, offering tools for automated payment generation and enhanced reconciliation.

Outcome: Increase Stripe's market share in the B2B payments segment by 8% within 18 months, attracting tech-forward businesses and capturing a larger share of evolving B2B transaction volumes. | Confidence: 85%

■ Evidence-Backed Strengths

1. Stripe's existing comprehensive suite of payment methods, including various local and alternative payment options, allows it to quickly adapt to evolving consumer preferences and maintain high conversion rates for its merchants.

Business Impact: This broad offering helps Stripe maintain high conversion rates for its merchants and prevents customer churn to competitors like Fiserv, who are expanding 'Pay by Bank' options, by ensuring merchants can cater to all customer preferences, thereby securing transaction volume and market position.

Source Evidence

2. Stripe's established position as a global, end-to-end payment provider with a unified platform.

Business Impact: This allows Stripe to offer a more seamless and scalable solution compared to competitors like GoCardless, who are just transitioning to an end-to-end model, or Mollie, who is acquiring to achieve this. This strengthens Stripe's market position by attracting businesses seeking a single, comprehensive payment partner, potentially increasing win-rates against these expanding

competitors.

Source Evidence

3. Stripe's modern, developer-first API infrastructure and flexible B2B payment solutions.

Business Impact: This provides a significant advantage over traditional players like J.P. Morgan Payments, whose scaling of digital card suites for B2B indicates a growing market need. Stripe's agility and ease of integration can attract tech-forward businesses, improving win-rates in the B2B segment and capturing a larger share of this evolving market.

Source Evidence

■■ Strategic Vulnerabilities

1. Stripe may have a weaker direct presence in regional banking partnerships for SMBs, particularly concerning integrated POS and business management platforms.

Risk Impact: Fiserv's partnership with Western Alliance Bank to offer Clover POS could lead to a loss of potential SMB merchant accounts for Stripe in the Western US, impacting market share and transaction volume in a key segment.

Risk Evidence

2. Stripe's competitive positioning for in-person payments among UK SMBs, especially against new, localized proprietary terminal solutions.

Risk Impact: Mollie's launch of its proprietary payment terminal and Tap app in the UK could erode Stripe's market share among UK SMBs seeking integrated online and offline payment solutions, potentially impacting transaction volume and merchant acquisition in this region.

Risk Evidence

3. Stripe's current standing and speed of adoption in the emerging Variable Recurring Payments (VRPs) market in the UK.

Risk Impact: GoCardless's involvement in the live testing and rollout of commercial VRPs with 'Recurring Pay by Bank' positions them as a first-mover. If Stripe lags, it could lose significant market share in the crucial UK recurring payments segment, affecting future revenue streams and competitive advantage.

Risk Evidence

■ Critical Market Events

1. Fiserv: Partnership

Expanded partnership with Ahold Delhaize USA to roll out Pay by Bank, a new digital payment option for online grocery orders.

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2. Fiserv: Partnership

Partnered with Western Alliance Bank to offer its Clover POS and business management platform, expanding its regional bank footprint in the Western United States.

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3. J.P. Morgan Payments: Partnership

J.P. Morgan Payments entered a strategic collaboration with Aspire to become a core FX provider, aiming to bolster Aspire's pricing structures, corridor access, and infrastructure resilience.

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4. J.P. Morgan Payments: Expansion

J.P. Morgan Payments is scaling its digital card suite across Europe to streamline B2B supply chains and travel payments, offering tools for automated payment generation and enhanced reconciliation, integrated with the Mastercard Wholesale Program.

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5. GoCardless: Partnership

GoCardless is being acquired by European payments fintech Mollie.

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6. GoCardless: Expansion

GoCardless is transitioning from a Direct Debit specialist to an end-to-end payment provider.

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7. GoCardless: Launch

GoCardless is involved in the live testing and rollout of commercial Variable Recurring Payments (VRPs) in the UK with its "Recurring Pay by Bank" solution.

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8. Mollie: Launch

Mollie launched its new proprietary payment terminal and Tap app to support UK SMBs with in-person payments.

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9. Mollie: Partnership

Mollie is preparing for a landmark acquisition of bank payment specialist GoCardless.

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■ Synthesized Market Analysis

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